Encryption and Decryption

Encryption and decryption are processes that ensure confidentiality that only authorized persons can access the information.

Encryption is the process of translating the plain text data (plaintext) into random and mangled data (called cipher-text).

Decryption is the reverse process of converting the cipher-text back to plaintext.Encryption and decryption are done by cryptography. In cryptography a key is a piece of information (parameter) that determines the functional output of a cryptographic algorithm.

Figure 17.9 shows the encryption and decryption process.

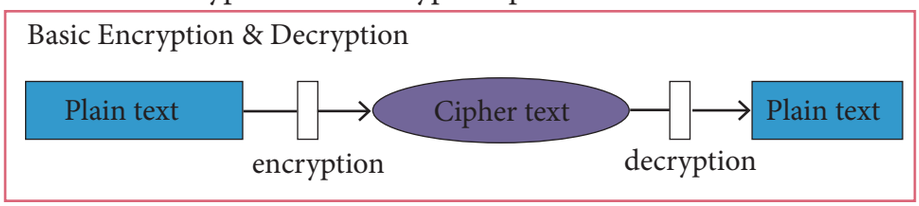

Figure 17.9 Encryption and Decryption

Encryption has been used by militaries and governments to facilitate secret communication. It is now commonly used in protecting information within many kinds of civilian systems. It is also used to protect data in communication system, for example data being transferred via networks (e.g. the Internet, ecommerce), mobile telephones, wireless microphones, wireless intercom systems, Bluetooth devices and bank automatic teller machines. There have been numerous reports of data in communication being intercepted in recent years. Data should also be encrypted when transmitted across networks in order to protect against the network traffic by unauthorized users.

17.4 INTRODUCTION TO INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY ACT

In the 21st century, Computer, Internet and ICT or e-revolution has changed the life style of the people. Today paper based communication has been substituted by e-communication. Accordingly we have new terminologies like cyber world, e-transaction, e-banking, e-return and e-contracts. Apart from positive side of e-revolution there is also negative side of computer, that is, the internet and ICT in the hands of criminals which has become a weapon of offence. Accordingly a new panel of members emerged to tackle the problems of cyber crimes in cyber space i.e. Cyber Law or Cyber Space Law or Information Technology Law or Internet Law.

In India Cyber law and IT Act 2000 , modified in 2008 are being articulated to prevent computer crimes. IT Act 2000 is an act to provide legal recognition for transactions carried out by means of **ElectronicData Interchange(EDI)** and other means of electronic communication. It is the primary law in India dealing with cybercrime and electronic commerce(e-Commerce). e-Commerce is electronic data exchange or electronic filing of information.

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